

small file that tells the player what order to play the tracks in. You can have multiple playlists that group tracks however you like. Just be sure that when you download the playlist to your player, you download the tracks on the playlist, too.

Speed up your transfers. Getting files to your player can be excruciatingly slow, especially when you do it often. But you can eke out a few more kilobits per second if you have the latest available software and firmware for the player. Check your manufacturer's site regularly for updated versions.

Check your settings. Most players let you adjust the sound and display to some degree. If you don't tweak your player's settings, you can only blame yourself for the trebly sound, for instance. Adjustments usually include an equalizer and balance, and many players let you adjust the backlight on the LCD, scroll speed for the display, and more.

Need some fresh music? Check out these sites when you need some new downloads.

- m Emusic offers unlimited downloads for \$10 a month, and those files are yours to reuse as you please, even if you end your subscription. You can burn the tracks to CD and transfer them to a portable player. The downside: The selection is a bit weak, with few major names or albums. Jazz and blues fans stand to gain the most.
- m Pressplay, available through Yahoo's Launch and MP3.com, has most of the major artists—from Eminem to Bruce Springsteen. It offers various subscription levels beginning at \$10 for unlimited downloads. For \$18, you can burn or transfer 10 tracks a month, and those tracks are yours to keep. Other downloads expire when you end your membership.
- m Amazon lets you try before you buy. It has a great Free Downloads section in its Music area. Many hot and up-and-coming acts can be found here. Check if the file is in MP3 format if you intend to transfer it to your player.